

MARVEL IN THE 1960s

Although it had published characters like Captain America, the Human Torch and the Sub-Mariner in the 1930s, 40s and 50s, the company that would become Marvel Comics had given up on Super Heroes when the 1960s began, and was only publishing monster comics, westerns and teenage romances. According to comic book legend, publisher Martin Goodman heard that the competition had launched a team of Super Heroes that was selling well. He asked his editor, Stan Lee, to come up with a new super-team. Stan developed the Fantastic Four and hired Jack Kirby as illustrator.

Launched as a bimonthly in 1961, *Fantastic Four* #1 was followed by *The Incredible Hulk* #1 in 1962. The same year saw the first appearances of Spider-Man in *Amazing Fantasy* #15, and Thor in *Journey Into Mystery* #83. Spider-Man received his own title in 1963, the year that also premiered *Avengers* #1, *X-Men* #1, *Sgt. Fury And His Howling Commandos* #1 and *Iron Man* in *Tales of Suspense* #39. *Daredevil* #1 appeared in 1964. With the launch of *Nick Fury, Agent of SHIELD* in 1968, Nick became the first character to simultaneously star in two series set during different time periods: World War II and the modern era!

SGT. FURY AND HIS HOWLING COMMANDOS #13 (1964)

In a story set during World War II, Captain America and Bucky join Sgt. Nick Fury to foil a typically fiendish Nazi plot.



FANTASTIC FOUR #1 (1961)
The Marvel Universe is born with a bimonthly title that introduces Mr. Fantastic, the Thing, the Invisible Girl and the Human Torch to the world.

TALES TO ASTONISH #44 (1963)
The Ant-Man gains a partner and meets his future wife when Janet Van Dyne becomes the Wasp and joins his series.



FANTASTIC FOUR ANNUAL #3 (1965)
Almost every Super Hero and Villain in the then Marvel Universe appears on the scene to celebrate the wedding of Reed Richards and Sue Storm. The guest list even includes a brief appearance by Stan Lee and Jack Kirby.



AMAZING FANTASY #15 (1962)
Marvel's most popular Super Hero—the always amazing Spider-Man—premieres in the last issue of a suspense comic. Peter Parker, Aunt May, Uncle Ben, and Flash Thompson all make their first appearances as Spider-Man learns that, "with great power there must also come great responsibility."



AMAZING SPIDER-MAN #39 (1966)
John Romita takes over the Wall-Crawler's art chores when Peter Parker is unmasked and captured by his greatest enemy: Norman Osborn, the original Green Goblin!

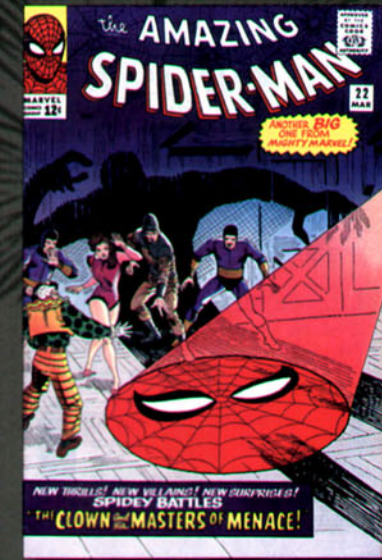


AVENGERS #4 (1964)
Stan Lee and Jack Kirby resurrect the original Captain America from the 1940s and reintroduce him to the modern age of comics.



MARVEL TALES #3 (1966)
As Marvel Comics became more popular, the company began to publish reprints of their earlier work so that readers could catch up on the histories of their favorite characters.

THE MIGHTY THOR #145 (1967)
As punishment for disobeying his father, Thor is stripped of his immortality and powers and abandoned on Earth. He lands a job working for the Ringmaster and his Circus of Crime.



AMAZING SPIDER-MAN #22 (1964)
The Webhead meets the Circus of Crime for the second time and battles the Ringmaster, the Clown, and Princess Python.

